

US and UK. In contrast, the most recent version of Humlum and Vestergaard (2025) found minimal effects on entry-level earnings or hours worked in Denmark.¹¹

3 Data Description

3.1 Payroll Data

This study uses data from ADP, the largest payroll processing firm in America. The company provides payroll services for firms employing over 25 million workers in the US. We use this to track employment changes for workers in occupations measured as more or less exposed to artificial intelligence.

We make several restrictions for our main analysis sample. We include only workers with positive earnings, exclude part-time employees, and subset to people under age 70.¹²

The set of firms using payroll services changes over time as companies join or leave ADP’s platform. We maintain a consistent set of firms by keeping only companies that have employee earnings records for each month from January 2021 through September 2025.

ADP observes job titles for about 70% of workers in its system. We exclude workers without a recorded job title. There are over 7,000 standardized job titles, including “Search engineer optimization specialist,” “Enterprise content management manager,” and “Plant documentation control specialist.” The company’s internal research team maps each of these job titles to a 2010 Standard Occupational Classification (SOC) code, additionally using information such as the job description, industry, location, and other relevant data. We use these estimated SOC codes to merge our data to occupational AI exposure measures.

After these restrictions we have records on 3.5 and 5 million workers each month for our main analysis sample, though we consider robustness to alternative analyses such as allowing for firms to enter and leave the sample.

While the ADP data include millions of workers in each month, the distribution of firms using

¹¹An important direction for future work is to reconcile differences among these recent studies, assessing the extent they arise from differences in labor market institutions, measurement of AI adoption, statistical methodology, or other factors.

¹²While we observe the year of birth for each worker, for privacy reasons we do not observe the exact date of birth. We impute month of birth from the distribution of birth months in the United States using data from the Center for Disease Control and Prevention.